- in Arunachal Pradesh by 80 per cent in the 2014–2018 period (compared with 30 per cent in 2009–2013, 20 per cent in 2004–2009);
- in Manipur by 114 per cent (28 per cent in 2009–2013, 23 per cent in 2004–2009);
- in Assam by 50 per cent (33 per cent in 2009–2013, 19 per cent in 2004–2009);
- in Mizoram by 63 per cent (29 per cent in 2009–2013, 38 per cent in 2004–2009);
- in Nagaland by 59 per cent (15 per cent in 2009–2013, 41 per cent 2004–2009);
- in Sikkim by 41 per cent (28 per cent in 2009–2013, 23 per cent in 2004–2009);
- in Tripura by 42 per cent (55 per cent in 2009–2013, 3 per cent in 2004–2009).

To be sure, the increase in electrification and nightlights was built on work done by the previous Congress-led UPA governments. Indeed, the early progress on this by UPA-1 (2004–2009) was impressive, but the independent NASA satellite data showed that the pace of growth slowed down in UPA-2 (2009–2013). It accelerated significantly after 2014, when the Modi government built on the successes of the previous governments, but increased the pace. So much so that in Arunachal, Manipur, Mizoram and Nagaland, the nightlight growth rate doubled. These figures testify to changes taking place in the Northeast and also explain why, when the Modi government talks of development in the Northeast, its slogans are not easily dismissed as the usual propaganda by local constituencies.

Figure 16.6: Nightlights Changed Drastically in the Northeast After 2014